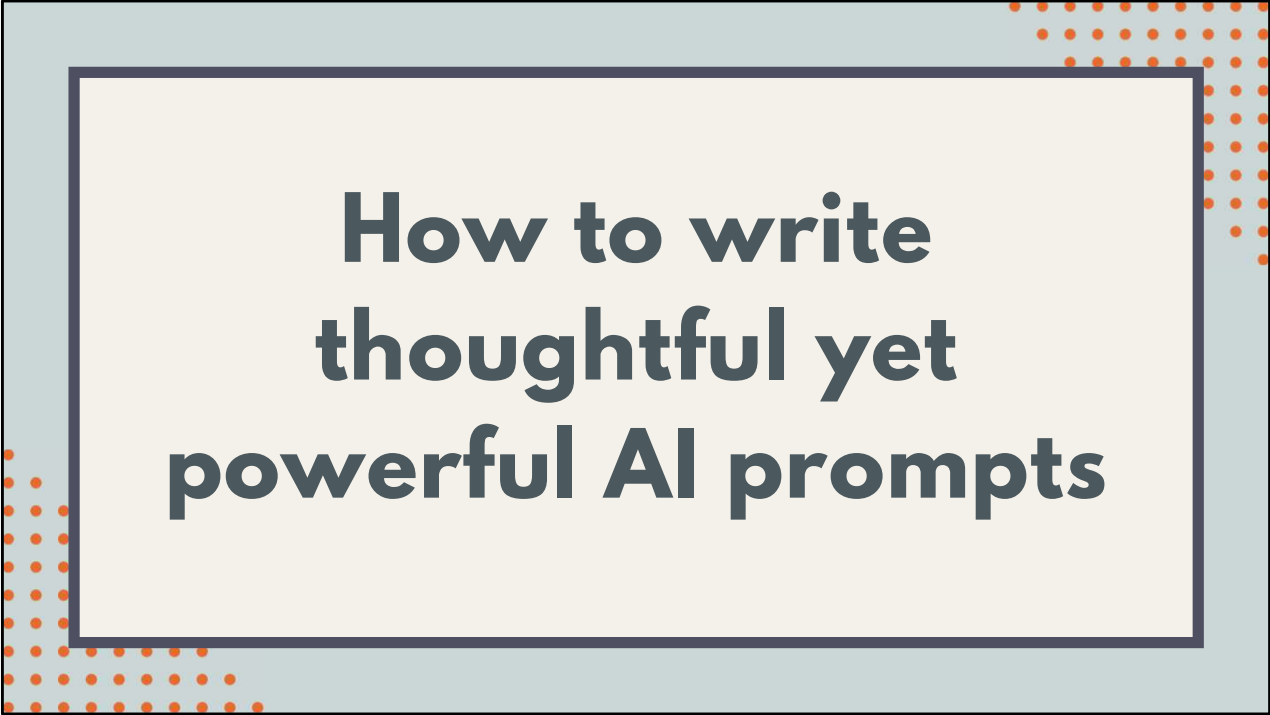




# How to write thoughtful yet powerful AI prompts

**Notes:**

For the purpose of this simulation, my target audience is an enterprise team of cross-functional instructional designers who are scaling AI tools. My front-end diagnostic assessment revealed that while 80% use AI daily, less than 20% utilize structured prompting frameworks, resulting in massive time leakage rewriting outputs.

# What do you use AI for?

In the chat, select your top 2 uses for AI by typing the numbers corresponding. If you have a different top use, type it into the chat.

1

Analyzing data

2

Brainstorming

3

Drafting copy

4

Exploring  
recipes

5

Advice Seeking  
*Queries*

6

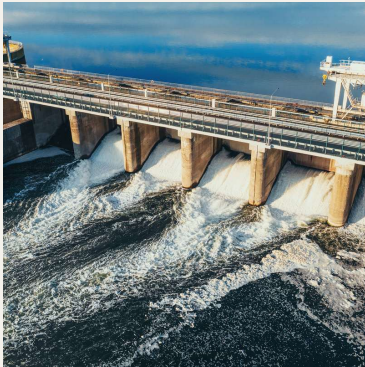
Correction/ editing  
*Identifying  
opportunities for  
improvement*

## Notes:

Time: 2-3 min.

Use this as an opportunity for discussion and introduction. Have participants add their responses in the chat. (Time: 2-3 min.)

## Why develop our own writing prompts?



AI usage requires a lot of energy and resources. So maximize your prompt for efficient generation vs. using a hit or miss approach.

### Notes:

Time: 2 min

Explains the why of making sure you write prompts efficiently and well.

## Importance of leveraging your human knowledge & power



- You are the Human-in-the-Loop.
- Start with what you know.
- Network and connect with others to fill in any knowledge and skill gaps.

### Notes:

Time: 2 min

Describes and entreats audience to remember their role in the usage of AI. AI is the ship/engine, we, the humans are the navigator/pilot. We shouldn't forget this.

## A so-so prompt vs. an excellent one

List any information you think is missing in the form of a question.

Write a course on customer service empathy.

### Notes:

Time: 3 min.

Ask the audience to share out loud what questions or asks would improve this prompt. In the blue screen rewrite the prompt with the team.

## Use **C.R.E.A.T.E.** to write powerful prompts

**C** - Character

**R** - Request

**E** - Examples

**A** - Additions

**T** - Type of Output

**E** - Extras

From Dave Birss -  
*How to Boost Your Productivity with AI Tools*

### **Notes:**

Time: 1 min.

Introduce the acronym

## C.R.E.A.T.E.

**C**

Character: What role should the AI be taking?

**R**

Request: What are you asking it to create?

**E**

Examples: What styles, approaches or examples should it apply?

**A**

Additions: What additional information or data should be considered?

**T**

Type of Output: What should the result look like or include?

**E**

Extras: Any additional questions that identify gaps?

### Notes:

Time: 1 min.

Each letter in the acronym answers a question. The goal of CREATE is to apply relevant knowledge to create an end product with the prompt.

# C.R.E.A.T.E.

**C**

**Character: What role should the AI be taking?**

An instructional designer with knowledge of Prosci Change Management.

**R**

**Request: What are you asking it to create?**

A project management plan outline for implementing an AI Course Assistant (LearnWise) for a 1 month runway. Include a period of user testing. Review workflow/steps/deliverables suggested by vendor.

**E**

**Examples: What styles, approaches or examples should it apply?**

Use Prosci Change Management to develop outline and action plan. Write Project iteration following S.A.M. design process.

**A**

**Additions: What additional information or data should be considered?**

Identify any potential opportunities or roadblocks based on previous projects X, Y, Z.

**T**

**Type of Output: What should the result look like or include?**

In this project management plan include an outline with a section with a suggested RACI chart that includes these roles - ID; Graphic Designer; PM; Stakeholder Leaders from X Depts; Program Leader; 5 Regional Mgrs; User Testers

**E**

**Extras: Any additional questions that identify gaps?**

Ask me any clarifying questions that provide you with data/information I may have missed.

**Notes:**

Time: 1 min.

Here are examples of the answers to each question.



## Final Prompt Example

As an instructional designer with knowledge of Prosci Change Management, develop a project management plan outline for implementing an AI Course Assistant (LearnWise) for a 1-month runway. Include a period of user testing. Review workflow/steps/deliverables suggested by vendor. Use Prosci Change Management to develop outline and action plan, Write Project iteration in SAM format. Identify any potential opportunities or roadblocks based on previous projects X, Y, Z.

In this project management plan include an outline with a section with a suggested RACI chart that includes these roles - ID; Graphic Designer; PM; Stakeholder Leaders from X Depts; Program Leader; 5 Regional Mgrs; User Testers.

Before putting this together, ask me any clarifying questions that provide you with data/information I may have missed.



### Notes: e

gfdgTime: 1 min.e

We won't spend a lot of time with this, but this is what a prompt might look like. It seems like a elot but it covers all of the questionsvbcvb

## Check your knowledge

Pick the prompts that work.

**C** - Character  
**R** - Request  
**E** - Examples  
**A** - Additions  
**T** - Type of Output  
**E** - Extras

**Prompt A:** Write an onboarding curriculum for new customer service agents. Include modules on empathy and using our CRM.

**Prompt B:** "Act as a Senior Learning Architect. Draft a 3-day onboarding curriculum outline for healthcare customer service agents. Use the ADDIE model framework. Focus the modules on empathetic de-escalation techniques and navigating an enterprise CRM system. Provide the output as a markdown table showing Module, Learning Objective, and Activity. Ask me clarifying questions about our specific CRM before you begin."

### Notes:

Time: 2.5 min.

Call out which one works. Explain how it's improved.

## Check your knowledge 2

Pick the prompts that work.

**C** - Character  
**R** - Request  
**E** - Examples  
**A** - Additions  
**T** - Type of Output  
**E** - Extras

**Prompt A:** *Act as an L&D Data Analyst. Review the following survey text metrics from our Q1 leadership course. Identify the top 3 themes where human judgment variability is causing inconsistent learner satisfaction scores. Output your findings as a bulleted executive summary with a 'Potential Roadblocks' section. If you need more context on our scoring scale, ask me first.*

**Prompt B:** Analyze this survey data and tell me why the scores are so different across our regions.

### Notes:

Time: 2.5 min.

Call out which one works. Explain how it's improved.

## Some final tips

- Record and share prompts that have great results with others.
- Allow others to improve your prompts iteratively.
- Start to recognize patterns where great results happen.

## Next steps - Recommendations for making it stick

1. Create a centralized prompt library for shared assets.
2. Offer prompt-tuning workshops using C-R-E-A-T-E or other methods, monthly or as needed. Showcase recent wins in staff meetings.
3. Share examples regularly of human-in-the-loop successes.

### Notes:

Time: 3 min.

To drive sustained use of the CREATE framework across the enterprise, we implement three pillars: 1) A centralized, searchable Prompt Library repository for shared assets, 2) Bi-weekly prompt-tuning workshops where peers iteratively improve workflows, and 3) Integrating these prompting standards into our standard operating templates so it becomes a natural part of our design workflow.

# **My Process**

The following slides review my design process.

## Implementation notes

**Decentralized Scale:** Packaged as a "Train-the-Trainer" asset with baked-in talking points, enabling any team lead to facilitate across the enterprise.

**Synchronous Collaboration:** Built for live virtual delivery (Zoom/Teams) utilizing integrated whiteboard sandboxes for real-time, peer-to-peer prompt drafting.

**Optimized Learning Dynamics:** Employs a dual-facilitator model (Presenter + Chat Moderator) to manage time, gain insight into learner inputs, and maximize engagement.

**Immediate Performance Support:** Followed by immediate distribution of the "**How to Write Powerful AI Prompts.pdf**" guide as a desktop job aid to ensure on-the-job utility.

**Continuous Micro-Learning:** Structured modularly so single slides can be pulled into weekly stand-ups or staff meetings for 5-minute "prompt-tuning" refreshers.

## My Human-Centered 12-Step Design Workflow

### Phase 1: Spot the Problem

#### Step 1: Look at the data



Start with the reality check: 80% of us use AI every day, but only 20% get results quickly. That's our starting line.

#### Step 2: Get to know the learners



Figure out exactly who we are designing for, how they currently work, and what's getting in their way.

#### Step 3: Define the win



Set a clear business goal: Help our teams stop guessing and start writing structured, reliable prompts that save them real time.

### Phase 2: Build the Blueprint

#### Step 4: Map out the journey



Use proven learning psychology (like Gagné and Bloom) behind the scenes to structure the lesson so it actually sticks.

#### Step 5: Hook their attention



Frame the opening around the "why." Show them that sloppy prompting wastes energy and time, while smart prompting makes creating good content and experiences easier.

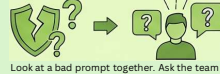
#### Step 6: Choose the delivery tools



Pick the perfect live-presentation activities and interactive features to make sure the session is highly engaging and accessible to everyone.

### Phase 3: Bring the Lesson to Life

#### Step 7: Challenge what they know



Look at a bad prompt together. Ask the team to poke holes in it and get them thinking and talking.

#### Step 8: Reveal the trick



Introduce the simple, CREATE acronym as their new step-by-step checklist for building a great prompt.

#### Step 9: Show, don't just tell



Walk through a real-world, highly detailed example of a prompt built with the CREATE framework so they can see it in action.

#### Step 10: Let them practice safely



Run a quick "Spot the Strategy" quiz where they look at good vs. bad examples to test their new skills.

### Phase 4: Make it Stick

#### Step 11: Build a support system



Give them tools to use after the class ends, like a shared prompt library and quick peer-review habits, so the new skill becomes second nature.

#### Step 12: Check back in on the data



Circle back to our original metric later on to measure how much we've moved that 20% efficiency baseline and celebrate the team's growth.

## My Human-Centered 12-Step Design Workflow

### Phase 1: Spot the Problem & Set Goals

#### Step 1: Look at the data

Start with the reality check: 80% of our team uses AI nearly every day, but only 20% are getting efficient results. That's our starting line.

#### Step 2: Get to know the learners

Figure out exactly who we are designing for, how they currently work, and what's getting in their way.

#### Step 3: Define the win

Set a clear business goal: Help our teams stop guessing and start writing structured, reliable prompts that save them real time.

### Phase 2: Build the Blueprint

#### Step 4: Map out the learning journey

Use proven learning psychology (like Gagné and Bloom) behind the scenes to structure the lesson so it actually sticks.

#### Step 5: Hook their attention

Frame the opening around the "why." Show them that sloppy prompting wastes energy and time, while smart prompting makes their jobs easier.

#### Step 6: Choose the right delivery tools

Pick the perfect presentation tools and interactive features to make sure the session is highly engaging and accessible to everyone.

### Phase 3: Bring the Lesson to Life

#### Step 7: Evoke what they know

Kick things off by looking at a bad prompt together. Ask the team to poke holes in it.

#### Step 8: Reveal the trick

Introduce the simple, CREATE acronym as their new step-by-step checklist for building a great prompt.

#### Step 9: Show, don't just tell

Walk through a real-world, highly detailed example of a prompt built with the CREATE framework so they can see it in action.

#### Step 10: Allow safe practice

Run a quick "Spot the Strategy" quiz where they look at good vs. bad examples to test their skills

### Phase 4: Make it Stick

#### Step 11: Build a support system

Give them tools to use *after* the class ends, like a shared prompt library and quick peer-review habits, so the new skill becomes second nature.

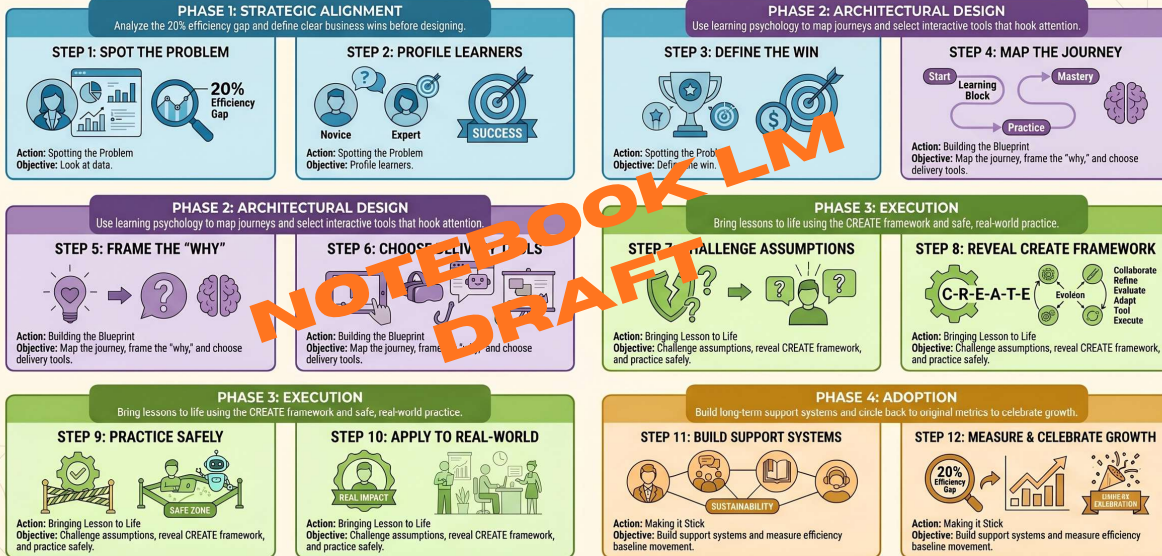
#### Step 12: Check back in on the data

Circle back to our original metric later on to measure how much we've moved that 20% efficiency baseline and celebrate the team's growth.



# My Human-Centered 12-Step Design Workflow

A holistic, enterprise-grade design lifecycle for AI training, moving from initial data analysis to long-term skill adoption.



## Make and Do - Crafting this Presentation



1. After doing initial design notes and outline in a paper journal, I designed the presentation flow in **Google Slides**. I cleaned up the design keeping it very simple.
2. Created a PDF of the presentation and uploaded it to **Gemini** and **Claude** asking them to give me specific feedback. I used some of the principles for prompt writing shared in the presentation, but asked it to give me feedback on clarity. I didn't like the language it shared so I would re-write the language to make it more approachable and human.
3. Created a graphic that illustrated my process. I had **Notebook LM** create a sketch given content and a prompt, but I was NOT pleased with the result. See slide 17 in extra slides. I did recycle the graphics created by NLM.
4. Tested my presentation with a colleague presenting in **Zoom**. Took in feedback and adapted with this feedback.
5. Used **Canva** to select a template - based selection on simple aesthetics and clarity.

### Tools used:

- Paper journal/ sketchbook
- Google Slides
- Gemini
- Claude
- Notebook LM
- Zoom
- Canva